

English Class 12th Poetic Devices

My Mother at Sixty-Six

1. Simile

"Ashen like that of a corpse" – The mother's face is compared to a corpse, reflecting fragility and nearing death.

"Pale as a late winter's moon" – Likens her face to a winter moon, symbolizing lifelessness.

2. Alliteration

"but after the airport's security check" – The repetition of the 's' sound highlights the setting.

"felt that familiar ache" – Repeated 'f' sound adds rhythm, enhancing emotional depth.

3. Repetition

"Smile and smile and smile" – Emphasizes the narrator's attempt to mask her sorrow.

4. Symbolism

Late winter's moon – Symbolizes aging and mortality, linking to the themes of loss and separation.

5. Imagery

Vivid images like "ashen like a corpse" evoke a strong sense of the mother's decline, visually connecting readers with the theme of mortality.

Keeping Quiet

1. Alliteration

"we will count", "we will all keep" – The repetitive sounds emphasize the theme of calm and introspection.

2. Repetition

"wars with gas, wars with fire" – Highlights the ongoing destruction due to human conflicts.

3. Symbolism

Man gathering salt – Symbolizes the suffering of humanity.

Green wars – Represents environmental destruction, emphasizing the need for peace.

Clean clothes – Implies purification and peace after self-reflection.

4. Personification

"earth can teach us" – The Earth is given human qualities, suggesting it imparts lessons on harmony.

5. Paradox

The poem suggests peace through inaction, highlighting the power of silence to promote unity.

A Thing of Beauty

1. Metaphor

Bower quiet – Represents a serene place that brings peace and joy.

2. Repetition

"Such the sun, the moon" – Repeated words underline the continuous blessings of nature.

3. Alliteration

"are we wreathing", "a flowery band to bind us" – Musical quality enhances the harmony of the poem.

4. Oxymoron

Mighty dead – Juxtaposes strength with death, symbolizing powerful historical figures.

5. Hyperbole

Endless fountain – Exaggerates nature's eternal beauty and abundance.

6. Symbolism

Endless fountain of immortal drink – Symbolizes everlasting beauty and hope that renews the human spirit.

7. Imagery

Visual elements like "mighty dead" and "simple sheep" evoke peaceful and vivid scenes, enhancing the theme of natural beauty.

A Roadside Stand

1. Alliteration

"the little old house was out with" – Adds rhythm and emphasis to the setting.

2. Repetition

"with N turned wrong and S turned wrong" – Reflects the despair and helplessness of rural poverty.

3. Personification

"A roadside stand that too pathetically pled" – The stand is given human qualities, symbolizing the desperation of rural life.

4. Metaphor

The flower of cities – Refers to urban allure, contrasting with rural struggles.

5. Irony

The wealthy city dwellers ignore the plight of the rural poor, highlighting the stark social disparity.

6. Imagery

Phrases like "wild berries in wooden quarts" paint a rich picture of rural life, contrasting it with the urban world.

By Thunderstudy

Aunt Jennifer's Tigers

1. Metaphor

"Bright topaz" – Compares the tigers' vibrant colors to precious stones, symbolizing strength.

"Ivory needle" – Represents Aunt Jennifer's controlled life.

2. Alliteration

"Fingers fluttering" and "weight of Uncle's wedding band" – Creates a rhythmic flow, emphasizing her struggle.

3. Synecdoche

"her terrified hands" – Represents Aunt Jennifer's overall fear and oppressed state.

4. Symbolism

Uncle's wedding band – Symbolizes the constraints of marriage and patriarchal dominance.

Tigers – Represent the freedom, strength, and courage Aunt Jennifer desires but lacks.

5. Imagery

Descriptions like "Bright topaz tigers" bring a vivid visual to her embroidered work, highlighting her creativity.